CONTACT BRIEF · PREPARED 9 NOV 2026 · FOR THE JEFFERSON AVE AND BLAND BLVD REMAINDER (ABOUT 12 ACRES)

Reaching Costco about the Newport News remainder

Renee Rutherford is the right starting point, but she is not the only door. This brief gives her title, base and public record, the Costco corporate and regional chain above her, Costco's exclusive outside broker for the Southeast, and the local players who actually carried the Newport News approvals. Direct lines marked "verify" come from third-party directories.

Costco closed on 32.37 acres at 12470, 12490 and 12500 Jefferson Ave on 31 Jul 2025 for $28M

Store opens November 2026; about 12 acres in two parcels to be sold off

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What the record says about the 12 acres

The conditional use permit (CU-2025-0003, Planning Commission 9-0 on 21 May 2025, City Council 10 Jun 2025) covers a 20.23-acre parcel. The staff report says Costco would buy all 32.37 acres from Ferguson, record a boundary line adjustment splitting the land into three parcels, build on the largest, and that "two remaining parcels (about 12 acres) will be held for future sale." News coverage put it plainly: "the remaining land will be split into two parcels, which the wholesale giant eventually will sell off." The Newport News EDA waived its repurchase rights on the Ferguson land and signed a $3.25M participation agreement with Costco for road and transit improvements at Jefferson and Bland. So the 12 acres are Costco's to sell, the city already expects a sale, and the EDA has a direct line into Costco from the agreement.

Renee Rutherford

Director of Real Estate Development, Eastern Division, Costco Wholesale

Call first

BASED IN RESTON, VIRGINIA · WORKS FROM COSTCO'S NORTHEAST REGION OFFICE IN STERLING · IN THE ROLE SINCE ABOUT 2006 PER DIRECTORIES

TITLE

Costco's own staff and most coverage: Director of Real Estate Development, Eastern Division. One June 2026 report called her assistant vice president for real estate development; treat that as unconfirmed.

PRESS RECORD

Every public appearance I can find is the Asheville, NC store at Enka Commerce Park. August 2025 neighborhood meeting ("This is the first part of a long approval process"). December 2025, declined to comment on the Economic Development Coalition's opposition. February 2026, Costco withdrew; she did not return the Asheville Watchdog's call. September 2026, emailed that Costco was "working to open this store as quickly as possible" and credited the mayor. October 13, 2026, told Asheville City Council groundbreaking would be summer 2027 and opening spring 2028.

NEWPORT NEWS

She does not appear in any Newport News coverage, hearing summary or city release. Costco's Newport News approvals were carried by local counsel (below), and the Chesapeake Greenbrier Costco approved in June 2026 was carried by the landowner's agent, not Costco staff. That is normal for Costco in Hampton Roads: the division director stays off the podium unless a site is contested.

WHY HER

She is the division-level decision maker for new units in the East and the person a surplus-land question lands with before it goes to Issaquah.

OFFICE	Costco Wholesale, Northeast Region office, 45940 Horseshoe Dr, Suite 150, Sterling, VA 20166. **703-406-6800**, fax 703-406-6994 (verify). Ask for Real Estate Development, Eastern Division.
EMAIL	Directories show r***@costco.com. Costco's pattern is first initial plus last name in roughly 90 percent of addresses, so **rrutherford@costco.com** is probable, unverified.
LINKEDIN	linkedin.com/in/renee-rutherford-618062a (Costco Wholesale, Director of Real Estate). InMail works for this profile type.
HQ SWITCHBOARD	Costco Wholesale Corporation, 999 Lake Dr, Issaquah, WA 98027. **425-313-8100**. Use only if Sterling does not pick up.

Opening that fits: you represent a regulated utility looking at 10 to 12 acres for a headquarters next to the new Newport News warehouse, you know the CUP left two parcels for future sale, and you would like to be first in line when Costco is ready to move them.

Sources: Asheville Watchdog, BPR, Mountain Xpress, Hendersonville.com, ZoomInfo and Salesflow directory records

BPR, Oct 2026

The rest of the Costco real estate chain

David Messner

Corporate

SENIOR VICE PRESIDENT, REAL ESTATE DEVELOPMENT · ISSAQUAH

Runs all of Costco real estate; listed on the investor relations executive page and current as of February 2026. Dispositions above a threshold clear through him. Reach through the Issaquah switchboard, 425-313-8100. Escalation door, not the first call.

Source: investor.costco.com executive officers — Costco IR

Erich Brann

East

DIRECTOR OF REAL ESTATE AND DEVELOPMENT · PRESENTED THE BEL AIR, MD STORE (JULY 2024)

A second East Coast real estate director who does go to the podium. If Rutherford's desk is Carolinas-heavy, Brann may own Maryland and Virginia. Ask the Sterling office which of them covers Hampton Roads.

Source: WMAR, Harford County agenda — WMAR

Peter Kahn

Corporate

ASSISTANT VICE PRESIDENT, REAL ESTATE DEVELOPMENT (DIRECTORY LISTING)

Sits between the division directors and Messner. Name only; no verified contact beyond the Issaquah switchboard.

Source: Comparably directory — Verify

Costco's outside broker and the Newport News locals

Northwest Atlantic Partners

Costco's exclusive broker

COSTCO'S EXCLUSIVE REAL ESTATE BROKER FOR NORTH AMERICA · HQ BELLEVUE, WA, 425-777-2186 · NORTHWESTATLANTIC.COM

JIM OSTROWSKI	Vice President, based in Sterling, Virginia. His profile says he "manages and directs new unit expansion for Costco Wholesale throughout the southeastern United States." The firm's published addresses use first name at northwestatlantic.com (brian@northwestatlantic.com for the Illinois managing broker), so jim@northwestatlantic.com is probable, unverified. No direct line published; the Bellevue number routes.

Northwest Atlantic assembles Costco's sites and negotiates its transactions. If Costco lists the Jefferson Ave remainder through anyone, Ostrowski either handles it or picks the local broker who does. He sits in the same Sterling building as Rutherford's office. This is the second call.

Sources: Commercial Observer interview with Messner; Northwest Atlantic site; LinkedIn

northwestatlantic.com

Lindsey A. Carney

Costco's Newport News counsel

CARNEY PATTERSON MEADE, PLC · 12350 JEFFERSON AVE, SUITE 370, NEWPORT NEWS, VA 23602

Presented the Costco CUP to the Planning Commission on 21 May 2025 and handled the fueling station conditions. 757-223-4535 (VPAP lobbyist record, verify). She drafted or reviewed the boundary line adjustment that creates the two sale parcels, so she knows their exact shape and timing. Worth a professional call; she may also be the one Costco hands the disposition to locally.

Sources: Newport News Daily, Citizen Portal hearing summaries, Super Lawyers, VPAP

Newport News Daily

Newport News EDA

Counterparty to Costco

FLORENCE KINGSTON, DIRECTOR OF DEVELOPMENT · DEREK PERRY, ASSISTANT DIRECTOR

The EDA waived its repurchase rights on the Ferguson land and signed the $3.25M participation agreement with Costco. The city has a signed agreement, a named Costco signatory, and an interest in seeing the 12 acres become an employment anchor rather than retail pads. Ask Kingston who signed for Costco and whether the EDA has heard Costco's timing on the remainder.

Sources: WAVY, Newport News EDA 2025 annual report

EDA annual report

Order of calls

1 **Sterling office, 703-406-6800, ask for Renee Rutherford, Real Estate Development, Eastern Division.** Same day, LinkedIn InMail and an email to rrutherford@costco.com. Name the parcels, the CUP, and the utility tenant.

2 **Jim Ostrowski, Northwest Atlantic Partners, Sterling.** Costco's own broker for the Southeast. Ask whether the Newport News remainder will be marketed and by whom.

3 **Florence Kingston, Newport News Development.** Who signed the participation agreement for Costco, and what has Costco said about the remainder since the store topped out.

4 **Lindsey Carney, Carney Patterson Meade.** Status of the boundary line adjustment and the configuration of the two sale parcels.

5 **Timing.** Costco said "eventually." Expect them to hold until the store opens in November 2026 and the BLA is recorded. A letter of interest on file before then puts you first when they decide.

Sources

- Asheville Watchdog: Costco officials on Enka plans (Rutherford) (https://avlwatchdog.org/costco-officials-plans-for-enka-site-will-be-submitted-to-city-of-asheville-in-2-to-4-weeks/)
- BPR, Dec 2025: Rutherford declines comment on EDC opposition (https://www.bpr.org/2025-12-10/proposed-costco-location-in-enka-opposed-by-economic-development-coalition)
- BPR, Feb 2026: Costco withdraws Asheville application (https://www.bpr.org/growth-development/2026-02-19/costco-withdraws-application-for-highly-anticipated-asheville-location)
- Hendersonville.com, Sept 2026: Costco resubmits (Rutherford email) (https://www.hendersonville.com/news/2026/09/costco-resubmits-asheville-store-plans-october-2026/)
- BPR, Oct 2026: Council approval, Rutherford on timeline (https://www.bpr.org/2026-10-14/asheville-city-council-gives-the-green-light-costco-store-to-open-in-2028)
- ZoomInfo: Renee Rutherford, Costco (title, masked email) (https://www.zoominfo.com/p/Renee-Rutherford/4159606759)
- Salesflow directory: Director of Real Estate Development, Eastern Division (https://salesflow.io/contact/renee-rutherford-director-of-real-estate-development-eastern-division/)
- Costco Regional Office, 45940 Horseshoe Dr, Sterling VA, 703-406-6800 (https://www.chamberofcommerce.com/united-states/virginia/sterling/corporate-office/26877336-costco-regional-office)
- Costco HQ switchboard, 425-313-8100 (https://corporateofficeheadquarters.com/costco-corporate-office-headquarters-hq/)
- Costco investor relations: executive officers (David Messner) (https://investor.costco.com/index.php/executive-officers)

- Commercial Observer: Messner on Costco real estate and its exclusive broker (https://commercialobserver.com/2022/02/dave-messner-costco-real-estate-sites-locations/)
- Northwest Atlantic Partners (https://northwestatlantic.com/)
- LinkedIn: Jim Ostrowski, VP, Northwest Atlantic Partners, Sterling VA (https://www.linkedin.com/in/jim-ostrowski-a9168b11/)
- WMAR: Erich Brann, Costco director of real estate and development, Bel Air (https://www.wmar2news.com/local/plans-for-bel-air-costco-get-sent-back-for-revision)
- Citizen Portal: Newport News Planning Commission, 21 May 2025 (20.23 ac CUP, 12 ac held for future sale) (https://citizenportal.ai/articles/6745841/virginia/newport-news-independent-city/planning-commission-recommends-costco-site-and-memberonly-fueling-station-at-jefferson-avenue)
- Daily Press via Yahoo: Council approves Costco relocation; remainder to be sold off (https://news.yahoo.com/newport-news-city-council-gives-003700700.html)
- WAVY: Costco buys former Ferguson HQ, 32 acres, $28M (https://www.wavy.com/news/local-news/newport-news/costco-expands-in-newport-news-moving-to-former-ferguson-hq/)
- Newport News EDA 2025 annual report ($3.25M Costco participation agreement) (https://newportnewsva.com/about/2025-annual-report/)
- Super Lawyers: Lindsey A. Carney, Carney Patterson Meade (https://profiles.superlawyers.com/virginia/newport-news/lawyer/lindsey-a-carney/8763e43c-13f9-4faf-89ae-8c501cba6d7f.html)
- VPAP: Lindsey A. Carney (phone) (https://www.vpap.org/lobbying/lobbyist/236872)
- City of Chesapeake: Greenbrier Costco PLN-USE-2025-048 council package (https://www.cityofchesapeake.net/DocumentCenter/View/31975/d__pln-use-2025-048-Greenbrier-Costco-2026-06-16-CC-Pkg-1)